

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal research, document drafting, structured case and file management, and communicating legal analysis clearly to non-specialist audiences. Experienced supporting complex disputes and regulatory matters at BCLP, Q-Legal and Citizens Advice, with a working knowledge of financial and data-protection regulation from roles at Adobe and Q-Legal. Looking to develop knowledge management skills within a high-volume finance practice.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Conducted legal research and drafted procedural histories and procedural orders to support a complex investment arbitration
- Amended substantive sections of the Claimant's memorial; managed document organisation and tracked outstanding actions as the sole junior on the matter approaching a significant submission deadline
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking across several matters simultaneously
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents with competing deadlines, flagging issues and keeping fee-earners informed

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Conducts detailed client interviews across welfare, employment, housing and debt matters; takes factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies key legal and evidential issues
- Researches complex statutory and regulatory points; assesses eligibility against legislative criteria and identifies evidential gaps

- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements; reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters